

HOUSE No. 4691**The Commonwealth of Massachusetts**

PRESENTED BY:

James K. Hawkins and Kelly W. Pease*To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:*

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing an Orange Star license plate for veterans exposed to Agent Orange.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>James K. Hawkins</i>	<i>2nd Bristol</i>	<i>8/15/2025</i>
<i>Kelly W. Pease</i>	<i>4th Hampden</i>	<i>8/21/2025</i>
<i>Shirley B. Arriaga</i>	<i>8th Hampden</i>	<i>9/9/2025</i>
<i>Michelle L. Badger</i>	<i>1st Plymouth</i>	<i>10/12/2025</i>
<i>Lisa Field</i>	<i>3rd Bristol</i>	<i>9/10/2025</i>
<i>Brandy Fluker-Reid</i>	<i>12th Suffolk</i>	<i>10/1/2025</i>
<i>Carmine Lawrence Gentile</i>	<i>13th Middlesex</i>	<i>9/11/2025</i>
<i>Ryan M. Hamilton</i>	<i>15th Essex</i>	<i>9/11/2025</i>
<i>Natalie M. Higgins</i>	<i>4th Worcester</i>	<i>9/25/2025</i>
<i>Patrick Joseph Kearney</i>	<i>4th Plymouth</i>	<i>9/10/2025</i>
<i>Kathleen R. LaNatra</i>	<i>12th Plymouth</i>	<i>9/9/2025</i>
<i>John J. Marsi</i>	<i>6th Worcester</i>	<i>9/9/2025</i>
<i>Brian W. Murray</i>	<i>10th Worcester</i>	<i>9/10/2025</i>
<i>Angelo J. Puppolo, Jr.</i>	<i>12th Hampden</i>	<i>9/10/2025</i>
<i>Alan Silvia</i>	<i>7th Bristol</i>	<i>9/18/2025</i>
<i>Mark D. Sylvia</i>	<i>10th Bristol</i>	<i>9/11/2025</i>
<i>Susannah M. Whipps</i>	<i>2nd Franklin</i>	<i>9/9/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 4691

By Representatives Hawkins of Attleboro and Pease of Westfield, a petition (subject to Joint Rule 12) of James K. Hawkins and Kelly W. Pease relative to establishing an Orange Star license plate for veterans exposed to Agent Orange. Transportation.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act establishing an Orange Star license plate for veterans exposed to Agent Orange.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 The registrar shall furnish, without charge to owners of private passenger motor vehicles
2 who reside in Massachusetts, the Orange Star plate. Upon evidence deemed satisfactory by the
3 registrar, registration plates bearing the Orange Star distinctive emblem that identifies Vietnam
4 veterans who have a documented medical condition that the VA attributes to service in Vietnam
5 for one private passenger motor vehicle or motorcycle owned and principally used by such
6 recipient; provided, however, that the surviving spouse of a deceased recipient may elect to
7 retain such distinctive registration plates or emblem for personal use upon payment of the
8 established registration fee for private passenger motor vehicles or motorcycles and an additional
9 annual twenty dollar fee until such spouse remarries or fails to renew or cancels such
10 registration. This recognition is not officially a military medal, but a symbol of appreciation for
11 those affected by Agent Orange.